

Bonus Baby Dave Roberts Could Be Padres' Big Man

By Joe O'Day

It's a dubious distinction picking first in the annual free agent draft each June because it means you were the worst team in the majors a year ago. But the San Diego Padres feel they grabbed off a ripe plum a month ago in bonus baby Dave Roberts, the current keeper of the flame at the hot corner.

Sitting on the bench before the Fourth of July doubleheader at Shea Stadium, manager Don Zimmer rolled his eyes and said: "He's there now... will be there next year and will be there for the next eight to 10 years. In another year-and-a-half, he'll be hitting home runs."

That's quite a recommendation for the 21-year-old Roberts, who a month ago to the day was tabbed No. 1 off the University of Oregon campus and signed a \$70,000 contract spread over two years.

Better Future at SD

"Buzzy Bavasi (club president) and Bob Fontaine (director of scouting) figured at 6-3 and 215 pounds that Dave would have more of a future at third base than at shortstop, where he played in college," Zimmer continued. "Actually, we figured he would make one road trip with us and then we'd send him to Duke (Snider) at Alexandria in the Texas League."

"But we got into an 18-inning game with the Pirates and I put him in there when I started to run out of players along about the 12th. He's been in there ever since and hasn't embarrassed the



Dave Roberts Takes his cut

club or, more importantly, himself.

"Sure, he's making mistakes but I can live with that and talk to him to correct them right here. If the Duke had him it wouldn't be all that easy because he has 25 guys to worry about."

Further evaluating Roberts' talents, especially as adjusting to third base, Zimmer added: "He's not stiff-backed like infielders his size and has what we call 'soft hands.' He made a great play on Johnny Bench of the Reds, catching a line drive in foul territory."

Asked how Roberts was handling major-league pitching, Zimmer declared: "Well, he was striking

Game Tonight

The rubber of the three-game series between the Padres and Mets last night at Shea Stadium was postponed because of rain and was rescheduled for tonight at 8:05. Tickets for last night's game will be honored.

The Mets walking wounded spent their day off yesterday being examined by club physician Peter Lamotte. The doctor listed this latest body count after taking x-rays:

Cleon Jones—no fracture; elbow sore; "still a day-to-day proposition."

Tommy Agee—groin is much improved; will be available for pinch-hitting duties.

Wayne Garrett—received cortisone injection in left knee; will not play today.

Dave Marshall—upset stomach; feels much better after day off. Will play.

Willie Mays—right hand still receiving whirlpool treatment.

Rusty Staub—not ready to be examined.

RUDE AWAKENING

—By Bill Gallo



that from the beginning? Well, he did and has been making good contact ever since. And another thing I like about him is that he's not scared... kids are awed by the majors but you can see that scared look in their eyes. It's not that way with Dave, though."

Young David, whose average swelled to .261 before drawing a nine-for-0 collar in the twin bill, was enthusiastic about the

long jump from the campus to the bigs.

"At first I was a little tight," the boyish-looking Roberts said, "but I'm becoming more comfortable. I don't like to strike out, of course, and as for playing third base, it's a get 'em or you don't get 'em thing. But, then, you try to take the things from shortstop over there and do the job."

Mets Batting

	AB	H	Ave.		AB	H	Ave.
Staub	208	62	.298	Beauchamp	47	11	.234
Martiz	135	40	.296	Greie	145	32	.221
Miller	146	41	.281	H'reison	250	52	.208
Dyer	100	27	.270	Kranepf	136	28	.206
Jones	194	49	.266	Garrett	18	15	.192
Agee	220	55	.250	Boswell	163	29	.178
Fregosi	211	53	.251				
Mays	131	31	.237				
Marshall	55	13	.236	Team	225	53	.235

All-Star Teams to End All All-Star Teams

THROUGH THE PRESS GATE

By Phil Pepe

"Mr. President, as the nation's No. 1 baseball fan, would you be willing to name your all-time baseball team?"

When President Nixon not only said he would but actually did, and made the sport pages of just about every newspaper in the country with his selections, that was an open invitation for everybody else to get into the act.

Therefore, in the interest of fair play, and because this is an election year, it seems only right that others be given equal time.

Unfortunately, they were unable to obtain expert advice since none of the selectors has a son-in-law who is an avid baseball fan, and could help with the selections. In those cases, I decided to lend my assistance after studying the record books for the purpose of compiling lists of stars that would stand up under the scrutiny such selections would receive from sports writers and baseball fans throughout the country.



Leonid Brezhnev The Godfather

Leonid Brezhnev
First base—Lefty O'Doul
Second base—Red Schoendienst
Third base—Red Rolfe
Shortstop—Pinky May
Outfield—Eric (The Red) Tipton
Outfield—Pinky Jorgensen
Outfield—Red Murray
Catcher—Red Down
Left-handed pitcher—Lefty Gomez
Right-handed pitcher—Nene Reserves:
Outfield—Red McDermott
Catcher—Red Kress
Pitcher—Red Ruffing

Don Vito Corleone
First base—Joe Pepitone
Second base—Tony Lazzeri
Third base—Joe Torre
Shortstop—Phil Rizzuto
Outfield—Joe DiMaggio
Outfield—Rocky Colavito
Outfield—Carl Furillo
Catcher—Yogi Berra
Left-handed Pitcher—Johnny Antonelli
Right-handed pitcher—Sal Maglie
Reserves:
Infield—Jim Fregosi
Outfield—Dom DiMaggio
Catcher—Ernie Lombardi
Pitcher—Ralph Branca



Frank Buck e. e. cummings

Frank Buck
First base—Moose Skowron
Second base—Emil (The Antelope) Verban
Third base—Snider Jorgensen
Shortstop—Rabbit Maranville
Outfield—Ducky Medwick
Outfield—Goose Goslin
Outfield—Mule Haas
Catcher—Hawk Taylor
Left-handed pitcher—Harry (The Cat) Brecheen
Right-handed pitcher—Old Hose Radbourn
Infield—Pinky Higgins
Reserves:
Infield—Marty (The Octopus) Morton
Outfield—Ox Eckhardt
Catcher—Harry (the Horse) Danning

e. e. cummings
First base—J. W. Porter
Second base—J. J. McCarty
Third base—L. I. Mathison
Shortstop—J. C. Hartman
Outfield—G. G. Walker
Outfield—R. E. Hildebrand
Outfield—C. V. Matherson
Catcher—J. C. Martin
Left-handed pitcher—W. A. Keatts
Right-handed pitcher—F. C. Hanson
Reserves:
Infield—W. B. Shanbrook
Outfield—D. F. Gallagher
Pitcher—W. W. Sharner



Golda Meir Alfred E. Smith

Golda Meir
First base—Ron Blomberg
Second base—Andy Cohen
Third base—Al Rosen
Shortstop—Eddie Feinberg
Outfield—Hank Greenberg
Outfield—Cal Abrams
Outfield—Goody Rosen
Catcher—Joe Ginsberg
Left-handed pitcher—Sandy Koufax
Right-handed pitcher—Saul Rogovin
Reserves:
Infield—Mike Epstein
Outfield—Sid Gordon
Catcher—Norm Sherry
Pitcher—Harry Eisenstadt

Gov. Alfred E. Smith
First base—Willie Smith
Second base—George Smith
Third base—Charlie Smith
Shortstop—Germany Smith
Outfield—Al Smith
Outfield—Reggie Smith
Outfield—Elmer Smith
Catcher—Hal Smith
Left-handed pitcher—Al Smith
Right-handed pitcher—Frank Smith
Reserves:
Infield—Al Smith
Outfield—Sherry Robertson
Catcher—Al Smith
Pitcher—Sheldon Jones



Graham Kerr Betty Friedman

Graham Kerr, The Galloping Gourmet
First base—Ham Patterson
Second base—Cookie Rojas
Third base—Pie Traynor
Shortstop—Chico Salmon
Outfield—Scappy Campbell
Outfield—Peanuts Lowery
Outfield—Lewie Sothers
Catcher—Pickles Dillhoefer
Left-handed Pitcher—Noodles Hahn
Right-handed Pitcher—Ray Lamb
Reserves:
Infield—Foggy Martin
Outfield—Sam Rice
Catcher—Steve Hefforth
Pitcher—Bob Vaile

Betty Friedman
First base—Gail Hopkins
Second base—Nellie Fox
Third base—Nanny Fernandez
Shortstop—She Donahue
Outfield—Minnie Minoso
Outfield—Evel Cradtree
Outfield—Babe Ruth
Catcher—Bobbie Hargrave
Left-handed pitcher—Dolly Gray
Right-handed pitcher—Grandma Murphy
Reserves:
First base—Mary Calhoun
Outfield—Sherry Robertson
Catcher—Peaches Grauman
Pitcher—Lil Stomer